

1. Information about the indicator	
Goal	Ensuring the availability and rational use of water resources and sanitation for all
Task	By 2030, ensure integrated water resources management at all levels, including, if necessary, through cross-border cooperation.
The indicator	The share of transboundary water basins covered by existing agreements on cooperation in the field of water use
2. Information about the organization	
Organization	Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation of the Republic of Kazakhstan
3. Definitions and concepts	
Definition	The share of transboundary water basins covered by existing agreements on cooperation in the field of water use is defined as the share of the area of transboundary water basins within a country covered by existing agreements on cooperation in the field of water use. It is derived as the ratio of the sum of the surface area of those transboundary catchment areas and transboundary aquifers (i.e., "transboundary" basins) in a country that are covered by current water use cooperation agreements to the total area of all transboundary basins (both catchment areas and aquifers) in the country. The result is multiplied by 100 to get a percentage expression.
Basic concepts:	The proposed control is based on the spatial coverage of transboundary basins shared by each country, and focuses on monitoring whether they are covered by existing cooperation agreements. Transboundary basins are basins of transboundary waters, that is, any surface waters (in particular rivers, lakes) or groundwater that mark, intersect or are located on the borders between two or more States. Organization of cooperation in the field of water resources: a bilateral or multilateral treaty, convention, agreement (interstate, intergovernmental, interdepartmental, regional) or memorandum of understanding between riparian countries within the framework of cooperation in the field of transboundary waters management. Operational: For an agreement or memorandum of understanding on cooperation between riparian countries to be considered operational, the following criteria must be met: Creation of a joint body, mechanism or commission (e.g. river basin organization) for cross-border cooperation; Ensuring regular official exchange of information between riparian countries in the form of meetings; Develop a joint or coordinated water resources management plan(s) or define common goals.
Justification and interpretation	The development of water resources has an impact on transboundary basins, potentially on neighboring countries, and the use of surface water or groundwater can affect another resource, usually they are interconnected. Intensive use of waters, regulation of runoff or the risks of their pollution jeopardize the development of neighboring countries, therefore, cross-border cooperation is required.
4. Data sources and collection methods	
Data sources	The source at the national level is information from ministries and

	departments responsible for surface and groundwater resources
Data collection methods	The data is provided from the administrative records of ministries or departments responsible for water resources
Unit of measurement	Percent
Periodicity	once every three years
5. Calculation method and other methodological considerations	
Calculation method:	The indicator is calculated in 5 steps: 1. Definition of transboundary surface waters and aquifers; 2. The surface area of each transboundary basin and the total area are calculated.; 3. The existing mechanism of transboundary cooperation in the field of water resources management and verification of transboundary waters covered by the mechanism of cooperation is being considered. 4. It is checked which of the existing mechanisms of transboundary cooperation in the field of water resources management are operational. 5. The value of the indicator, that is, the share of the region, is calculated by adding the surface area in the country of those transboundary surface water basins or aquifers that are covered by operational cooperation and dividing it by the total total area in the country of all transboundary basins (including aquifers) multiplied by 100 to obtain a percentage.
Comments and restrictions:	Spatial information on the boundaries of transboundary surface water basins and on the extent of the catchment area is usually available and essentially static; therefore, once determined, there is no need for constant updating. Information about the actual extent of transboundary aquifers may evolve over time, as such information is usually raw, but tends to improve due to the updated knowledge about aquifers. Technical research and information exchange will improve delineation and may also lead to the identification of additional transboundary aquifers. In situations where more than two riparian countries share basins, but only some of them have cooperative arrangements, the value of the indicator may hide a gap that the riparian country does not have, as well as cooperation with its neighbors. Such additional information can be obtained by aggregating data at the basin level, but not from reports at the national level. The legal framework for cooperation is developing slowly: the conclusion of new agreements on transboundary waters is usually a very long process that takes many years. The efficiency of cooperation is more dynamic, as it develops with the expansion of cooperation. It can be expected that responsiveness will develop in a shorter time frame, as a result of which, in a year or two, progress can potentially be observed.
6. Data availability and disaggregation	
Data availability and gaps:	The data has not yet been included in national statistical systems, but the information needed to calculate the indicator does not require advanced monitoring capabilities and is usually available to all countries in ministries or departments responsible for water resources.
The level of disaggregation:	Data at the national level. At the basin level, data can also be disaggregated at the country level (for national reporting) and reduced

	to regional and global levels.
7. Comparability with international data/standards	The UNECE and UNESCO-IHL reports under the Convention on the Protection and Use of Transboundary Watercourses and International Lakes (hereinafter referred to as the Convention on Transboundary Waters) also collect the information necessary for calculating the indicator, especially with regard to cooperation mechanisms, the transboundary waters they cover, and how expeditious they are. The regular reporting of the Convention on Transboundary Water Cooperation, involving both Parties and non-Parties to the Convention on Transboundary Waters, will collect this information every 3 years as of 2017. The reporting covers transboundary rivers, lakes, and groundwater. UNESCO's IHL will facilitate reporting on transboundary aquifers. More than 100 countries are involved in activities under the Convention on Transboundary Waters. The United Nations Economic Commission for Europe acts as the secretariat of the Convention on Transboundary Waters. Some countries are already reporting to regional organizations (for example, the European Union or the Southern African Development Community) on improved cooperation in the field of transboundary waters, and similar mechanisms can be strengthened and facilitated.
8. References and documentation	http://www.unece.org/env/water.html http://www.unece.org/fileadmin/DAM/env/documents/2015/WAT/11Nov_1719_MOP7_Budapest/ECE_MP.WAT_2015_7_reporting_decision_ENG.pdf http://www.transboundarywaters.orst.edu/publications/atlas/index.html http://www.unece.org/env/water/publications/pub/second_assessment.html http://www.geftwap.org/